



VINAY RAJA

Director, In-House Creative Agency

IN-HOUSE AGENCY BUILD · OPERATING MODELS · AI-ENABLED PRODUCTION

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Creative leader with twenty years building and transforming in-house creative functions across B2B and B2C. Rebuilt a five-person design team into a specialist studio serving eleven markets and four brands at PageGroup, then built AVJennings' in-house agency from nothing and proved its return on creative investment. **Treats efficiency as capability funding, not cost reduction:** the gain buys seniority and time for conceptual work.

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Creative Director

Tydal Agency · Sydney · Sep 2025 to present

Senior-only creative studio for property developers, delivering in-house agency capability through retained and project engagements on a fixed-cost model.

REMIT

- Own positioning, service design, pricing, delivery and client relationships. Structured by discipline, so the right specialist does the work.

IMPACT

- Built an AI-powered design system, translating brand guidelines into working design systems across several platforms, and used it to produce a full campaign on live client work. Production moved from seven days to two, though approval cycles do not compress at the same rate.
- Building the layer around the model: structured briefing, audience validation, methodology for matching system to deliverable, and guardrails so brand adherence is built in.

Creative & Digital Experience Director

AVJennings · Sydney · Apr 2018 to Sep 2025

Built the in-house agency from nothing. It began as an experiment to test whether the model could work at all, and had to prove return on creative investment within twelve months to survive.

REMIT

- Owned the in-house agency across roughly twenty communities and 250 to 300 lot releases a year. **Set the creative standard and acted as the final quality gate** for all in-house work, from concept to execution.
- Built and led the five-person in-house agency within a fifteen-person marketing function, serving ten project marketers who reported to the CMO.
- **Serviced the wider business, not marketing alone:** Acquisitions, Corporate, Customer Service and the home and community Design team, none of which reported to me. Advised each on what they needed and how the agency could solve it, rather than taking orders.
- **Owned and managed a \$1M annual budget**, together with the retained agency panel and platform vendor relationships.

IMPACT

- **Cut external creative agency fees from \$1.5M to \$2M a year down to roughly \$750K**, reducing agency dependency from nine agencies to three specialist partners.
- Established the operating system: templates across every project and masterbrand, briefing and review workflows, approval governance and asset management, enabling teams across the business to self-publish on brand while governance held. Studio ran at 70 to 80 percent production efficiency. Led the platform move from a legacy CMS to headless architecture, business case and executive sign-off included.
- Launched multiple project brands and rebranded large established estates in a regulated category, each with masterbrand-scale demands across naming, identity, collateral and digital.
- **Proved return on creative investment.** Instrumented the studio against hours, work type and delivered impact, reporting to the C-suite monthly for twelve months. Each quarter the data set the improvement plan: repeatable work redesigned, some outputs rebuilt, others retired entirely, with the released capacity going back into conceptual work.

CAPABILITY

- In-house agency build and transformation
- Creative operating models and workflow
- Traffic, capacity and production governance
- Brand systems and multi-channel rollout
- External agency and vendor partnership
- AI-enabled production systems
- Team leadership and capability building
- B2B and B2C creative direction
- Digital platform and CMS ownership
- Executive communication and advisory

CRAFT

Twenty years hands-on before and alongside leadership: art direction, brand identity, campaign development, print and digital production, video, motion and UX/UI. Still the final quality gate rather than a reviewer of other people's decisions.

TOOLS

Design and production

Adobe Creative Suite, Figma, Framer

Platforms

Storyblok, Sitecore, WordPress, Drupal

Performance

GA4, Hotjar, Crazy Egg

AI production stack

Claude Projects and MCP-connected tooling across design, analytics, content and project systems; agent workflows mapped across business development, delivery, operations and marketing

Workflow

ClickUp, Agile and sprint-based delivery

EXPERIENCE CONTINUED

Head of Creative Services, Asia Pacific

PageGroup · Singapore and Sydney · Jun 2014 to Mar 2018

Transformed an existing production function into a full-service in-house agency while it continued to deliver, with no pause in output.

REMIT

- Owned creative services across Asia Pacific: brand application, campaign creative, content and production for four brands across eleven markets and three audience tiers, serving candidate and employer audiences simultaneously.
- Set creative and art direction standards across global, regional and local initiatives, and led the regional in-house agency, structured as specialists by discipline plus a studio manager.
- Held the external agency relationship alongside internal delivery, setting the line between what the studio produced and what partners did.
- Accountable for regional output at high volume: over 100 videos and roughly 2,000 assets a year.

IMPACT

- **Inherited five graphic designers.** Rebuilt them as a full-service in-house agency, specialists by discipline across print, web, user experience, video and photography, funded by efficiency taken out of repeatable production rather than new budget. Delivered through a restructure I proposed and led, changing the shape of the team rather than adding to it.
- Launched new brands into new markets, taking brand presence from zero to live under commercial deadline.
- Ran campaigns across multiple languages, adapting content to local market insight rather than translating it, so regional work landed as local work.
- Built the regional video content strategy and production plan in house.

Founder & Creative Director

Infigo · Melbourne and Singapore · Dec 2013 to Jun 2015

- Mobile-first hospitality service product. Led brand, UX/UI and product strategy through to a working MVP.
- Awarded USD 50,000 seed funding through the Start-Up Chile accelerator.

EARLIER

Founder, Plasmatic, open source systems integration venture, 2025 to present · Owner and Creative Director, Visualcrave Studio, 2012 to 2014 · Design Manager Asia, Kobian, 2011 to 2012 · Art Director, Singapore Straits Wine Company, 2008 to 2011, leading a retail chain brand redesign across South East Asia · Senior Graphic Designer, Venturer Design, Singapore, 2007 to 2008 · Graphic Designer, Real Image Media Technologies, India, 2003 to 2006

EDUCATION

- Postgraduate Diploma, Innovation and Design Thinking, Massachusetts Institute of Technology, delivered with Emeritus, 2020 to 2022
- Master of Design, Digital Media Design, Swinburne University of Technology, 2013
- Diploma in Communication Design, LaSalle College of the Arts, Singapore, 2007
- Diploma in Multimedia Production, SAE Technology College, India, 2002
- Certified Practising Marketer, CPM, Australian Marketing Institute

DEVELOPING PEOPLE

Ten years leading teams on one principle: empower people to become the best version of themselves. Built multidisciplinary capability rather than replacing it.

- **No one I hired or set out to keep has resigned.** None across four years at PageGroup, one across seven years at AVJennings
- Currently mentoring on the Australian Marketing Institute Emerging Marketers programme

RECOGNITION

- Brandie Awards, Reader's Digest Marketing Awards and International Property Awards
- Start-Up Chile seed funding, USD 50,000, for Infigo
- Acoustic Angle, speaker system crowdfunded through Indiegogo, designed for a patented Involve Audio technology

FURTHER READING

A written account of the operating model behind all three rebuilds, including where AI is and is not currently useful:

vinayraja.com/jobs/betashares

DETAIL

Sydney based, full-time, on site. Australian work rights.